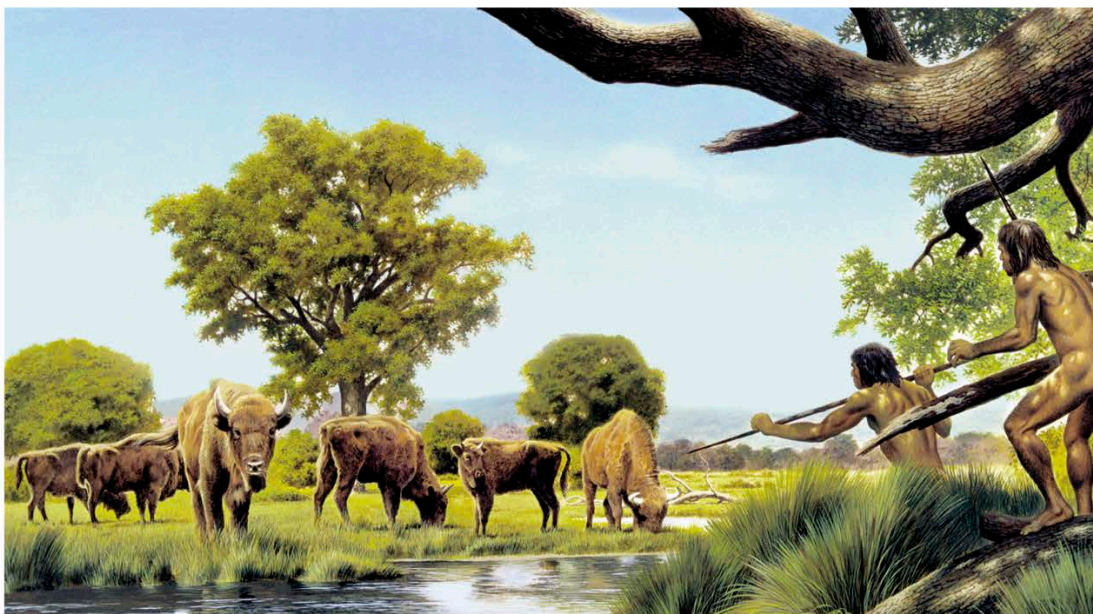




◀ HOMO HEIDELBERGENSIS

Named after Heidelberg in Germany, where their remains were first found, Homo heidelbergensis emerged around 700,000 years ago. They were the first species to build shelters and regularly hunt large animals, using wooden spears. They moved from Africa into Europe, which then had a warm climate, and continued to evolve—becoming Homo neanderthalensis in Europe and Asia and Homo sapiens in Africa.

▼ MAKING FIRE

Homo erectus are thought to have been the first species to have used fire for cooking. This made it easier to digest meat, which may have led to the growth of bigger brains and smaller teeth. Fire also offered protection from predators, and allowed groups to stay active in the dark. Sitting around a fire may have encouraged the development of language.



The Homo neanderthalensis skull is longer and flatter than a modern human's.



Burning wood from lightning strikes was used to build the first fires.

◀ NEANDERTHALS

Our closest relatives, Homo neanderthalensis, lived in western Asia and Europe from 400,000 years ago. They had brains as big as a modern human's and wore animal-skin clothing. There is evidence that they buried their dead with offerings of flowers.

CHILD IN TIME

Turkana Boy is the nickname of this young Homo ergaster—a variety of Homo erectus—whose almost complete skeleton was found in Kenya in 1984. He lived 1.6 million years ago. Although he was only between 7 and 11 years old, he was almost fully grown, at 5 ft 3 in (1.6m) tall.

